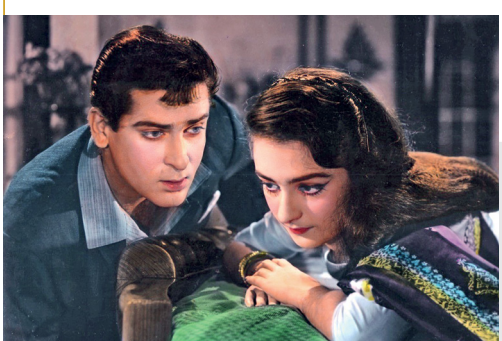


Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge

(1995, Colour)

A modern love story upholding family and traditional values, *DDLJ* came as a breath of fresh air and was well in sync with the changing India of the 1990s. With the success of his debut feature, multi-talented Aditya Chopra re-established the romantic film as the mainstay of popular Hindi cinema. He also encouraged a whole new set of behind-the-scenes talent, including Farah Khan and Karan Johar. Following the film's release, Shah Rukh Khan and Kajol were counted among the best-loved romantic screen pairs. Great performances, lively songs and dances underpin this now-cult blockbuster that still runs and runs.



Junglee

(1961, colour)

No list of influential films is complete without a Shammi Kapoor starrer. Excelling in many 1960s films, he is undoubtedly the model for the 1990s heroes—carefree young men who dance well and love madly. Setting a formula for the romantic film for many decades, Subodh Mukherjee's uplifting movie can also be credited with creating the craze of using Kashmir as a song backdrop. A confident star, Shammi Kapoor was happy to be cast opposite newcomers. Here, the lovely Saira Banu is in her first film. *Junglee*'s happy ending is a given; it's Shammi Kapoor's charisma that's fresh and innovative.

Sholay

(1975, Colour)

A surprisingly slow starter, Ramesh Sippy's epic multi-starrer has great action sequences, popular music by R.D. Burman, and many dramatic storylines, all brought together seamlessly in a tightly knit Salim-Javed screenplay. Individually, everyone in the excellent cast creates unforgettable and distinctive characters, some leading the narrative and others appearing in only a few scenes, while its villain, Gabbar Singh (the remarkable Amjad Khan), famously went on to become an enduring cult figure. *Sholay* continues to enjoy its own unique status for audiences across generations. It has also given filmgoers some of Hindi cinema's most quotable quotes.



INDIA PICTURE